TIER 1 ADOPTION NOTICE

SAE1025, “Failure Mode and Effects Analysis (FMEA) Includes Criticality Analysis and Design, Supportability, Software, and Process FMEA”, was adopted on August 15, 2026, for use by the Department of War (DoW).

SAE1025 is a comprehensive Failure Mode and Effects Analysis (FMEA) standard that also includes Criticality Analysis and applies to design, supportability, software, and process risk management. Its purpose is to provide a single, authoritative, and up-to-date framework for identifying, assessing, mitigating, and preventing risks across the product life cycle. It supersedes older standards, like the canceled MIL-STD-1629A, by incorporating current engineering tools and techniques.

To address modern technological advancements, this unified standard defines a cohesive risk mitigation methodology integrating Design (DFMEA), Software (SwFMEA), Supportability (SupFMEA), and Process (PFMEA) analyses alongside Process Flow Diagrams and Control Plans. Crucially, it resolves historical industry confusion by formally treating Criticality Analysis (FMECA) as an inseparable, core component of the broader FMEA process, rather than a separate exercise.

The standard emphasizes that FMEAs must be initiated early in the preliminary design stages to serve as active decision-making tools, preventing costly downstream redesigns while ensuring continuous configuration control. By maintaining these analyses as living documents throughout the operational lifecycle, organizations can effectively leverage field experience to continually improve system safety, reliability, and supportability.

Proposed changes by DoW activities must be submitted to the DoW Adopting Activity osd.pentagon.ousd-r-e.mbx.sea@mail.mil, and include Attn: Specialty Engineering in the subject line. The standard may be purchased at https://www.sae.org/standards/sae1025-failure-mode-effects-analysis-fmea-includes-criticality-analysis-design-supportability-software-process-fmea or via SAE World Headquarters, 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096-0001.

AMSC N/A Area: SESS

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